SSC MTS 2023 question paper with answers

12 September 2023 · Shift 2

44 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: 3 marks a question; no negative marking in Session-I (Numerical and Mathematical Ability, Reasoning), 1 mark deducted for each wrong answer in Session-II (General Awareness, English).

The other 46 of the paper's 90 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20231223070914/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/Writeup_MTS2023_22122023.pdf

General Awareness 19 questions

Q.1

How many countries participated in the FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup 2022?

(A) 18
(B) 14
(C) 16
(D) 12

Q.2

'Wings of Fire' is the autobiography of a former president of India. Who is he?

(A) Shankar Dayal Sharma
(B) APJ Abdul Kalam
(C) Zakir Hussain
(D) VV Giri

Q.3

In which of the following states is the Statue of Unity situated?

(A) Gujarat
(B) Rajasthan
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Punjab

Q.4

When was the Defence of India Act enacted?

(A) 1920
(B) 1918
(C) 1915
(D) 1921

Q.5

Which festival brings out the fusion rich culture of Chhattisgarh and Odisha?

(A) Rath Yatra
(B) Bastar Goncha
(C) Shoolini fair
(D) Madhavpur fair

Q.6

Which flag of the Indian National Congress was adopted in 1931?

(A) A two colour flag with charkha made by cloth
(B) A tricolour flag made by Khadi with a Charkha symbol
(C) One colour flag with charkha symbol
(D) A blue colour flag made by cloth

Q.9

Which of the following vitamins prevents major birth defects of the brain and spine of a newborn baby?

(A) Vitamin E
(B) Vitamin A
(C) Vitamin C
(D) Folic acid

Q.10
In India, the National Sports Day is celebrated on which date?

(A) 6th December
(B) 29th August
(C) 1st September
(D) 14th November

Q.12
Which of the following playback singers of India received the Padma Shri in 2009 and Padma Bhushan in 2016?

(A) Sonu Nigam
(B) Abhijit Bhattacharya
(C) Kumar Sanu Bhattacharjee
(D) Udit Narayan Jha

Q.13
When the 'trans-boundary economic activities' of an economy and depreciation are included into account, the aggregate measure is known as _____.

(A) GNP
(B) NNP
(C) PCI
(D) GDP

Q.14
Tamil Nadu's _____ marked a national record in men's long jump in the second AFI National Jumps Competition in March 2023.

(A) Suresh Babu
(B) Anees Yahiya
(C) Murali Sreeshankar
(D) Jeswin Aldrin

Q.16
Which mountain range from the following is associated with Rajasthan state?

(A) Satpura Range
(B) Sahyadri Range
(C) Aravalli Range
(D) Vindhya Range

Q.17
According to the National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2021, which state has the lowest percentage of population being multidimensionally poor?

(A) Kerala
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Rajasthan

Q.18
Which of the following represents disposable income?

(A) The income earned by individuals and households after taxes and other deductions
(B) The total income earned by businesses and corporations in an economy
(C) The income earned by individuals through their own business or self-employment
(D) The total income earned by individuals and households before taxes and other deductions

Q.19
Which of the following states receives rainfall during the winter season?

(A) Tamil Nadu
(B) Jharkhand
(C) Maharashtra
(D) Rajasthan

Q.21
Who was our first Prime Minister?

(A) Rajendra Prasad
(B) Indira Gandhi
(C) Jawaharlal Nehru
(D) Gulzarilal Nanda

Q.22
Which state is ranked fourth in India according to the first Multidimensional Poverty Index (MPI) 2021 report of the NITI Aayog?

(A) Meghalaya
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Assam
(D) Himachal Pradesh

Q.23
Which Schedule of the Indian Constitution deals with the division of powers between the Union and the states?

(A) 9th
(B) 7th
(C) 5th
(D) 2nd

Q.25
Renowned _____ folk dance artist Domar Singh Kunwar, who has dedicated his life to preserving the tradition of the dance for over five decades, was awarded the Padma Shri 2023.

(A) Pandwani
(B) Raut Nacha
(C) Natya Nacha
(D) Soowa

English Language and Comprehension 25 questions

Q.1
Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. Beat around the bush

(A) To avoid talking about what is important
(B) To talk about important things
(C) To have patience
(D) To avoid people

Q.2
Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. A person who is kept captive for fulfilment of demands of money or conditions.

(A) Doyen
(B) Bait
(C) Hostage
(D) Scion

Q.3
Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Peril

(A) Danger
(B) Entertainment
(C) Joke
(D) Ignorance

Q.4
There is a spelling error in the given sentence. Select the option that contains the INCORRECTLY spelt word. As per manager's opinion, the laser sprinkler malfuntioned.

(A) malfuntioned
(B) sprinkler
(C) laser
(D) opinion

Q.5
Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Amiable

(A) Restless
(B) Unfriendly
(C) Sad
(D) Joyful

Q.6
Select the most appropriate idiom to fill in the blank. Rahul speaks easily in front of a small group, but he seems _____ before a large audience.

(A) ill at ease
(B) think ill of
(C) man of ill repute
(D) ill-disposed to

Q.7

Select the most appropriate idiom for the following sentence. He made the business profitable from unprofitable in about a year of joining.

(A) Easy come, easy go
(B) Throw up
(C) Where there is a will, there is a way
(D) Still waters run deep

Q.8

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains a misspelt word. “Obesity” is “rapidly” becoming the “leading” cause of “prevantable” deaths in the United States.

(A) rapidly
(B) leading
(C) obesity
(D) prevantable

Q.9

Identify and correct the INCORRECTLY spelt word in the given sentence. Sliding each bead from one side to the other, the student used the abacus to count out the nember of days in a week.

(A) beed
(B) number
(C) Slaiding
(D) abacuss

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No improvement required’. Very early in the morning, at the beginning of January, Opu was lying in bed “waiting for the sun having rose.”

(A) waited for the sun rising
(B) waited for the sun having rose
(C) No improvement required
(D) waiting for the sun to rise

Q.11

Choose the sentence that contains an error.

(A) I love the taste of fresh strawberries in the summer.
(B) She is the winner of the Nobel Peace Prize.
(C) He is chef who specialises in Italian cuisine.
(D) The Earth revolves around the Sun.

Q.12

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select ‘No improvement required’. Newton, after seeing the apple falling from a tree, “began to wonder whether if” it moved towards the earth and not upwards towards the sky.

(A) No improvement required
(B) began to wondering if
(C) began his wondering how
(D) began to wonder why

Q.13

Select the most appropriate option that can substitute the underlined word in the following sentence. They “serve” stuffed garlic bread and molten chocolate in the birthday party of their son, Parth, last week.

(A) served
(B) serves
(C) are serving
(D) be served

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. Barbed

(A) Passive
(B) Kind
(C) Gentle
(D) Spiteful

Q.15

Select the most appropriate meaning of the underlined segment in the given sentence. I can't believe you “let the cat out of the bag” about my surprise party!

(A) Ask a question
(B) Reveal a secret
(C) Keep a secret
(D) Make a joke

Q.16

Select the option that can be used as a one-word substitute for the given group of words. Endless period of time

(A) Eternity
(B) Longevity
(C) Impurity
(D) Frailty

Q.17

Parts of the given sentence have been underlined. One of them contains an error. The underlined parts are given as options with some changes. Select the option that correctly rectifies the error. Sohan is “the” “older” brother “of my” “best” friend.

(A) to my
(B) an
(C) elder
(D) good

Q.18

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. We think “of the past” history of the world “as fixed” but of the future “as undecided” and open to a “wealth off” possibilities.

(A) of the past
(B) as undecided
(C) as fixed
(D) wealth off

Q.19

Parts of the following sentence have been given as options. Select the option that contains an error. My teacher told me that / all that / glitters was not gold.

(A) My teacher told me that
(B) all that
(C) glitters was not gold
(D) No error

Q.20

Parts of the following sentence have been underlined and given as options. Select the option that contains an error. “When” I “bought” the book, I “thought” it “will” be interesting.

(A) When
(B) bought
(C) will
(D) thought

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Education should be free to all because it is a (1)__ human right. It is essential for the (2)___ of a fully functioning society and for the advancement of humanity. While some argue that education should not be free because it has value or that free education would be a (3)__ on taxpayers, the reality is that education is a public good that (4)__ everyone in society. Not only does education provide individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to participate in the workforce, but it also improves social cohesion and creates more (5)__ citizens.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 1.

(A) lovely
(B) precious
(C) fundamental
(D) joyful

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Education should be free to all because it is a (1)__ human right. It is essential for the (2)___ of a fully functioning society and for the advancement of humanity. While some argue that education should not be free because it has value or that free education would be a (3)__ on taxpayers, the reality is that education is a public good that (4)__ everyone in society. Not only does education provide individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to participate in the workforce, but it also improves social cohesion and creates more (5)__ citizens.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 2.

(A) celebration
(B) development
(C) enthusiasm
(D) distribution

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Education should be free to all because it is a (1)__ human right. It is essential for the (2)___ of a fully functioning society and for the advancement of humanity. While some argue that education should not be free because it has value or that free education would be a (3)__ on taxpayers, the reality is that education is a public good that (4)__ everyone in society. Not only does education provide individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to participate in the workforce, but it also improves social cohesion and creates more (5)__ citizens.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 3.

(A) focus
(B) contentment
(C) burden
(D) blessing

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Education should be free to all because it is a (1)__ human right. It is essential for the (2)___ of a fully functioning society and for the advancement of humanity. While some argue that education should not be free because it has value or that free education would be a (3)__ on taxpayers, the reality is that education is a public good that (4)__ everyone in society. Not only does education provide individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to participate in the workforce, but it also improves social cohesion and creates more (5)__ citizens.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 4.

(A) sections
(B) emphasises
(C) burdens
(D) benefits

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Read the passage carefully and select the most appropriate option to fill in each blank. Education should be free to all because it is a (1)__ human right. It is essential for the (2)___ of a fully functioning society and for the advancement of humanity. While some argue that education should not be free because it has value or that free education would be a (3)__ on taxpayers, the reality is that education is a public good that (4)__ everyone in society. Not only does education provide individuals with the skills and knowledge they need to participate in the workforce, but it also improves social cohesion and creates more (5)__ citizens.

Select the most appropriate option to fill in blank number 5.

(A) easy going
(B) apprehensive
(C) productive
(D) authentic

Answer key

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(B)**	Q.12 **(D)**	Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(A)**	Q.19 **(A)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 **(A)**	Q.2 **(C)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.7 **(C)**	Q.8 **(D)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(C)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(B)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(C)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(C)**	Q.20 **(C)**	Q.21 **(C)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(C)**	Q.24 **(D)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

Explanations

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) 16

Sixteen teams took part in the 2022 FIFA U-17 Women's World Cup, held in India in October 2022.

Q.2 · Answer (B) APJ Abdul Kalam

'Wings of Fire' (1999), written with Arun Tiwari, is the autobiography of A. P. J. Abdul Kalam, President of India from 2002 to 2007.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Gujarat

The Statue of Unity, of Sardar Vallabhbhai Patel, stands near Kevadia in Narmada district, Gujarat, facing the Sardar Sarovar Dam.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 1915

The Defence of India Act was passed in 1915, during the First World War, giving the government wide emergency powers of detention and trial.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Bastar Goncha

Bastar Goncha is Bastar's own form of the Rath Yatra, held at Jagdalpur, Chhattisgarh: by tradition it began after a Bastar ruler's pilgrimage to Jagannath at Puri in Odisha, and it joins that worship to Bastar's own customs, such as the salute fired with bamboo 'tupki' guns.

Q.6 · Answer (B) A tricolour flag made by Khadi with a Charkha symbol

In 1931 the Congress adopted as its flag a tricolour of saffron, white and green with a charkha (spinning wheel) at the centre.

Q.9 · Answer (D) Folic acid

Folic acid (vitamin B9) taken before and early in pregnancy prevents neural tube defects, such as spina bifida and anencephaly, of the baby's brain and spine.

Q.10 · Answer (B) 29th August

National Sports Day is celebrated on 29 August, the birthday of the hockey player Major Dhyan Chand.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Udit Narayan Jha

The playback singer Udit Narayan received the Padma Shri in 2009 and the Padma Bhushan in 2016.

Q.13 · Answer (A) GNP

SSC's key gives GNP: adding the net factor income from abroad (the 'trans-boundary' activities) to GDP gives GNP, which, being a gross measure, still includes depreciation. The wording is loose, since 'taking depreciation into account' could also be read as deducting it, which would give NNP.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Jeswin Aldrin

Jeswin Aldrin of Tamil Nadu jumped 8.42 m at Ballari, Karnataka, in March 2023, a national record, beating Murali Sreeshankar's 8.36 m.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Aravalli Range

The Aravalli Range runs across Rajasthan from south-west to north-east; its highest peak, Guru Shikhar, is at Mount Abu. The Satpura lies in Madhya Pradesh and Maharashtra, and the Sahyadri is the Western Ghats.

Q.17 · Answer (A) Kerala

In NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2021 (baseline report), Kerala had the lowest share of multidimensionally poor people, 0.71%.

Q.18 · Answer (A) The income earned by individuals and households after taxes and other deductions

Disposable income is what individuals and households have left to spend or save after paying taxes and other compulsory deductions.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Tamil Nadu
SSC's key gives Tamil Nadu: in the cold season the north-east winds pick up moisture over the Bay of Bengal and blow onto its coast, so it gets rain (its north-east monsoon, October to December) while most of India is dry. Western disturbances also bring light winter showers to north-west India, parts of Rajasthan included, but Tamil Nadu is the state known for winter rainfall.

Q.21 · Answer (C) Jawaharlal Nehru
Jawaharlal Nehru was India's first Prime Minister, from 1947 until his death in 1964. Rajendra Prasad was the first President, and Gulzarilal Nanda twice served as interim Prime Minister.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Madhya Pradesh
In NITI Aayog's National Multidimensional Poverty Index 2021 (baseline report), Madhya Pradesh had the fourth-highest share of multidimensionally poor people, 36.65%, after Bihar (51.91%), Jharkhand (42.16%) and Uttar Pradesh (37.79%).

Q.23 · Answer (B) 7th
The Seventh Schedule, read with Article 246, divides powers between the Union and the states through the Union List, the State List and the Concurrent List.

Q.25 · Answer (C) Natya Nacha
Domar Singh Kunwar of Balod district, Chhattisgarh, a Nacha (Natya Nacha) folk theatre artist, received the Padma Shri in 2023. Raut Nacha is a different dance, of the Raut (Yadav) community, and Pandwani is a ballad form telling the Mahabharata.

English Language and Comprehension

Q.1 · Answer (A) To avoid talking about what is important
To 'beat around the bush' is to avoid coming to the point.

Q.2 · Answer (C) Hostage
A 'hostage' is a person held captive until demands, such as a ransom, are met.

Q.3 · Answer (A) Danger
'Peril' means serious danger.

Q.4 · Answer (A) malfuntioned
The correct spelling is 'malfunctioned'.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Unfriendly
'Amiable' means friendly and pleasant; its opposite is 'unfriendly'.

Q.6 · Answer (A) ill at ease
To be 'ill at ease' is to feel uncomfortable or nervous, as Rahul does before a large audience.

Q.7 · Answer (C) Where there is a will, there is a way
'Where there is a will, there is a way': determination finds a way to succeed, as in turning a loss-making business round within a year.

Q.8 · Answer (D) prevantable
The correct spelling is 'preventable'.

Q.9 · Answer (B) number
The misspelt word is 'nember', correctly 'number'. 'Beed', 'Slaiding' and 'abacuss' are misspellings of words the sentence spells correctly.

Q.10 · Answer (D) waiting for the sun to rise
One waits for something 'to' happen: 'waiting for the sun to rise'. 'Having rose' is wrong in any case (rise, rose, risen), and 'waited' does not fit after 'was lying in bed'.

Q.11 · Answer (C) He is chef who specialises in Italian cuisine.
'Chef' is a singular countable noun and needs an article: 'He is a chef who specialises in Italian cuisine.'

Q.12 · Answer (D) began to wonder why
'Wonder why' asks for the reason, which is what Newton puzzled over; 'whether if' doubles two words that do the same job.

Q.13 · Answer (A) served
'Last week' puts the action in the past, so the simple past 'served' is needed.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Spiteful
'Barbed' words are meant to hurt: 'spiteful', as in a barbed remark.

Q.15 · Answer (B) Reveal a secret
To 'let the cat out of the bag' is to reveal a secret, often by accident, here the surprise party.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Eternity
'Eternity' is time without end; 'longevity' is long life.

Q.17 · Answer (C) elder
SSC's key gives 'elder': traditional usage keeps 'elder' for comparing members of the same family, 'the elder brother'. 'Older brother' is also common and accepted today, so the error is one of textbook usage; 'an', 'to my' and 'good' correct nothing.

Q.18 · Answer (D) wealth off
'Off' should be the preposition 'of': 'a wealth of possibilities'.

Q.19 · Answer (C) glitters was not gold
A proverb or universal truth keeps the present tense even after a past reporting verb: 'all that glitters is not gold'.

Q.20 · Answer (C) will
After the past 'thought', the future in the past is 'would': 'I thought it would be interesting.'

Q.21 · Answer (C) fundamental
'A fundamental human right' is the usual phrase for a basic right owed to everyone, the passage's case for free education.

Q.22 · Answer (B) development
Education is essential for the 'development' of a fully functioning society, its growth into one.

Q.23 · Answer (C) burden
A 'burden on taxpayers' is a cost they must carry, the objection the passage answers.

Q.24 · Answer (D) benefits
A public good 'benefits' everyone in society, which is the passage's point; 'burdens' would contradict it.

Q.25 · Answer (C) productive
Education gives people the skills to work, so it creates more 'productive' citizens.

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